A great Australian scientist



Imagine you are walking along a corridor. It is 1965. You can smell chickens. The Walter and Eliza Hall Institute of Medical Research is not where you expect to smell a hen house! You follow your nose and walk into a neat, spotless laboratory. A gentleman with a starched white lab coat over his suit stands at the bench with an egg in his hand.

You have stumbled upon Sir Frank Macfarlane Burnet (1899–1985) who won a Nobel Prize for his work in **immunology**, the study of disease resistance, in 1960. Mac, as his colleagues knew him, was Australia's most celebrated scientist. He researched dozens of topics in immunology and **virology** (the study of viruses) as well as other areas, including ageing.

Burnet used egg membranes to grow **viruses**, including the influenza virus, which is related to bird viruses. While he was a great thinker, he was also a practical scientist who spent half of each day in his laboratory conducting experiments.

☞ **1** Use the word bank to complete the following passage.

Word bank

viruses immunology experiments Prize important Nobel disease resistance sciences Walter ageing

The Nobel _____ is a prestigious award given for peace, literature and various _____. Burnet's work was mostly in virology but he won the _____ Prize for an advance in _____. Chicken eggs were used to grow viruses and Burnet carried out very _____ work on influenza. Although he was very busy as Director of the _____ and Eliza Hall Institute, he still did _____ every day. His contribution to our understanding of disease, immunity and _____ was outstanding.

Virologists study _____ and immunologists study _____ _____.

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